A cut motion, to be admissible, must satisfy the following conditions:

(i) It should relate to one demand only.

(ii) It should be clearly expressed and should not contain arguments or defamatory statements.

(iii) It should be confined to one specific matter.

(iv) It should not make suggestions for the amendment or repeal of existing laws.

(v) It should not refer to a matter that is not primarily the concern of Union government.

(vi) It should not relate to the expenditure charged on the Consolidated Fund of India.

(vii) It should not relate to a matter that is under adjudication by a court.

(viii) It should not raise a question of privilege.

The significance of a cut motion lies in: (a) facilitating the initiation of concentrated discussion on a specific demand for grant; and (b) upholding the principle of responsible government by probing the activities of the government. However, the cut motion do not have much utility in practice. They are only moved and discussed in the House but not passed as the government enjoys majority support. Their passage by the Lok Sabha amounts to the expressions of want of parliamentary confidence in the government and may lead to its resignation.

On the last day of the days allotted for discussion and voting on the demands for grants, the Speaker puts all the remaining demands to vote and disposes them whether they have been discussed by the members or not. This is known as 'guillotine'.

5. Passing of Appropriation Bill The Constitution states that 'no money shall be withdrawn from the Consolidated Fund of India except under appropriation made by law'. Accordingly, after the demands for grants are voted on and passed by the Lok Sabha, an appropriation bill is introduced to provide for the appropriation, out of the Consolidated Fund of India, of all money required to meet:

(a) The grants voted by the Lok Sabha.

(b) The expenditure charged on the Consolidated Fund of India.

No such amendment can be proposed to the appropriation bill in either house of the Parliament that will have the effect of varying the amount or altering the destination of any grant voted, or of varying the amount of any expenditure charged on the Consolidated Fund of India.

The Appropriation Bill becomes the Appropriation Act after it is assented to by the President. This act authorises (or legalises) the payments from the Consolidated Fund of India. This means that the government cannot withdraw money from the Consolidated Fund of India till the enactment of the appropriation bill. This takes time and usually goes on till the end of April. But the government needs money to carry on its normal activities after 31 March (the end of the financial year). To overcome this functional difficulty, the Constitution has authorised the Lok Sabha to make any grant in advance in respect to the estimated expenditure for a part of the financial year, pending the completion of the voting of the demands for grants and the enactment of the appropriation bill. This provision is known as